

PRIVATE - NOT FOR THE CLIENT

Project Playbook

Running VastuFirst like a professional

Everything you need to run this project end to end - from the things to settle before you write a line of code, through the contract, the phases, the money, launch, and the specific ways this particular project can go wrong. Written for the fact that it is your first.

The deal	Rs 1,25,000 across 5 phases, paid on sign-off, plus a 5% passive royalty on revenue . Covers Android, iOS, the brand website and regular consultancy through the build . Roughly 3.5-4.5 months. Settled - this document assumes it.
Your position	Passive quality partner under a service agreement. Not a legal partnership . She owns the business, the marketing, the ad budget and every running cost. She is also a friend - see Part 0.6.
What is already done	Market research, the proposal, a working prototype with a live rules engine, and a 143-rule knowledge base now going to expert review.
Live risks	Plan-reading is unsolved. The expert review may force a rebuild of the zone engine. Flats may be a weak market. You cannot see her revenue unless the contract says you can.

The one-line summary

The Rs 1,25,000 is not the point. The royalty and the reference are. Almost everything in this document exists to protect those two things - and the first item, your job, matters more than either.

PART 0

Before you write a line of code

Four things to settle first. Skip them and nothing later in this document saves you.

Read your employment contract before you sign hers

You work full-time at a large, US-headquartered financial services company. Before you sign anything, read your **employment contract, the employee handbook and the code of conduct** yourself. Look for exactly three things:

- 1. Outside employment / moonlighting.** Does it prohibit outside work, require disclosure, or require pre-approval? Many large firms require at least disclosure.
- 2. IP assignment.** This is the one that can actually hurt. Broad clauses assign anything you create during employment to the employer. If yours is broadly worded, your claim to the Vastu engine - and to the royalty built on it - is not as clean as you think.
- 3. Conflict of interest.** A Vastu app does not compete with Amex, so the conflict risk is genuinely low. But an **ongoing 5% financial interest in an outside business** is the kind of thing disclosure policies are written for.

What to do: read the documents rather than asking a colleague. If disclosure is required, disclose - being found out is far worse than asking. And never use company time, laptop, network, email or accounts. Not once, not for five minutes. That is the thing that turns a policy question into a termination.

Why this is item zero: the downside here is not losing Rs 1,25,000. It is losing the salary that makes taking Rs 1,25,000 for four months' work affordable in the first place.

0.5 iOS is in scope. Here is what that actually requires.

The fee covers Android, iOS, the website and consultancy. That is decided. What follows are the constraints that come with it - none of them negotiable, all of them cheaper to solve now than in month three.

- 1. Kotlin Multiplatform is now mandatory, not a preference.** Two separate native codebases at this fee is not survivable. KMP with Compose Multiplatform shares most of the logic and the UI, matches the Kotlin/Compose you already work in, and is the only architecture that makes this scope fit. **Decide this before Phase 1 architecture, not after.** Retrofitting KMP onto an Android-only codebase in Phase 4 would cost more than the whole iOS scope.
- 2. You do not own a Mac, and iOS cannot be built, signed or shipped without macOS.** Xcode is Mac-only - Apple's licensing, not a preference. Your options, cheapest first:
 - **Codemagic free tier: 500 build minutes a month**, enough for a solo developer to build, sign and push to TestFlight. Costs nothing. **Start here.**
 - **Cloud Mac** (MacinCloud, MacStadium) at roughly Rs 2,000-2,500 a month, when you need real Xcode debugging rather than just a build. Budget for a month or two of this near the end.
 - **Buying a Mac mini** costs roughly half your entire fee. Do not.
- 3. You need an iPhone to test on.** Your phone is an Oppo. The simulator will not catch what ships. Borrow one for the QA phase, or buy a used unit - and get TestFlight onto a real device before launch, not after.
- 4. Her recurring costs go up.** The Apple Developer Program is about Rs 8,300 a year, every year, on top of the Play Store. Put it in the running-costs list in the contract so it is unambiguously hers.
- 5. App Store review is stricter than Play.** Apple rejects thin fortune-telling apps under guideline 4.3. Your floor-plan engine and reports are the reason you pass - the app is a genuine utility, not a horoscope. Build the review submission to say exactly that.

0.6 She is a friend. That is the biggest risk in this document after your job.

You said, a few weeks ago and in these words: *"I want to be really a passive partner with five percent, not ten, because I have tried partnerships before and I do not like it. I cannot be held responsible for not pushing the whole business forward."*

We priced 5% **because** you are passive. We wrote *not a legal partnership* into the terms. And now the scope includes **consultancy throughout, for a friend, with no cash attached**.

That is a partnership. You have kept the obligation and dropped the upside.

The fix is not to refuse - it is to **bound it**. Consultancy *during the build, ending at launch* is fine and belongs in scope. Consultancy *forever, because she is a friend* is the trap, and it is the exact shape of the thing that burned you before. Write down what it covers, when it stops, and what happens after: paid, or not at all.

And the counterintuitive part: the contract protects the friendship. Friends do not fall out over paperwork. They fall out over ambiguity - six months in, when nobody wrote down what "help" meant, and one of them feels used while the other feels abandoned. Every awkward conversation you have now is one you do not have angrily later.

You have already given the friend discount. Rs 1,25,000 against a Rs 3-6 lakh market rate *is* the friendship rate. She does not also get iOS for free, unlimited scope, and permanent advisory. One of those, not all four.

0.2 Tax and money admin

Set this up once, properly, and you will reuse it for every project after this one.

- **GST:** the registration threshold for services is Rs 20 lakh of turnover a year. You are far below it. **Do not register and do not charge GST.** Write "Not registered for GST" on your invoices.
- **Income tax:** this income stacks on top of your salary and is taxed at your slab. Declare it. A royalty does not stop being taxable because it is small.
- **Section 44ADA** presumptive taxation (50% deemed profit) may apply to you. Have a CA confirm whether your work qualifies - it is worth the one conversation.
- **Separate bank account** for project money. Not legally required. Makes your accounting trivial and your invoices look like a business rather than a favour.
- **Keep every receipt** - Groq, Supabase, hosting, the domain, your 60% of the Claude subscription, the Play Store fee. These are deductible business expenses.

0.3 Never start without a signed contract

This is the most common way first-time freelancers lose money, and it never feels like a risk at the time. "We trust each other", "let's just start", "we'll paper it later." No.

A contract is not distrust - it is clarity, and it protects her as much as you. More practically: **without a signed agreement you have no enforceable claim to the royalty.** In three years, when the app is earning, "we agreed on 5%" in a WhatsApp thread is a weak place to stand.

0.4 Phase 1 money arrives before Phase 1 work

Rs 25,000 on signing, to begin work. Not on delivery of Phase 1 - on signing. This is completely standard and any client who pushes back on it is telling you something useful for free.

PART 1

The contract

Do not use a generic template. These specific clauses matter for this specific deal, and two of them are the whole ballgame.

1.1 Scope - and the out-list matters more

In: the app as defined by the five phases, and the brand website.

Explicitly out - write these down: marketing and growth, ad spend, all running costs (Groq, Supabase, hosting, Play Store, Apple Developer), new features, human consultations, content work beyond the knowledge base, and anything not named in a phase. The out-list is what protects you. The in-list is just a promise.

In, explicitly: the Android app, the iOS app, the brand website, and product/technical consultancy during the build. Write all four down - especially iOS, so that "feature parity on both platforms" never becomes an argument in month three about what was assumed.

Consultancy - bound it in writing. "Product and technical advice during the build, ending at launch." Name the end date. After launch it is paid, or it is nothing. An unbounded advisory clause is the partnership you said you did not want, wearing a different hat.

1.2 The royalty clause - the most important thing you will write

Say REVENUE, not profit. Define it precisely: *gross receipts from the app and website, net only of payment-gateway fees and app-store commission*. Not net of salaries, marketing, hosting, her time, or "costs".

Why this matters: **profit can be engineered to zero forever.** A founder who spends everything on growth has no profit for years, and your 5% of nothing is nothing while the business compounds. Revenue cannot be argued away.

Also nail down: it starts at launch; it is paid quarterly within 30 days of quarter end; it applies to **all** revenue lines (subscriptions, reports, remedy store, affiliate, ads, and consultations if she adds them later); and it **survives** your involvement ending, the app being sold, and the company changing hands.

1.3 Audit rights - what makes 5% real

You are passive by choice, which means you cannot see the numbers unless the contract says you can. Keep it light: she sends a quarterly statement with the payment, and you have the right to see Play Store console and Razorpay revenue reports once a year on request. You are not auditing her books - you are checking two dashboards. Without this, your royalty is faith-based.

1.4 IP - decide this now, not at handover

Two clean options:

- (a) **Assign everything on final payment.** Simple, she owns it all. But she can then drop you and keep the engine you built.
- (b) **Licence it to her** - exclusive, perpetual, **contingent on the royalty being paid.** Stop paying, licence terminates.

My recommendation - the middle path: assign the **app IP** to her, but retain the **Vastu knowledge base and rules engine** as your own, licensed to her exclusively for this product. That knowledge base is the thing you researched, built, corrected against primary sources and are having expert-reviewed. It is a reusable asset with value well beyond this app. **Do not hand it over for Rs 1,25,000.**

1.5 Exit and acquisition

If she sells the app or the company, your royalty must either survive the sale or convert to **5% of the sale proceeds**. Without this clause an acquisition ends your upside overnight - and an acquisition is the single most likely way this ever pays you properly. If she shuts it down, you get nothing and owe nothing; that is fair.

1.6 Change requests

Anything not named in a phase is a change request: written, quoted, approved *before* work starts. Have an hourly or day rate decided now, in private, so you are never inventing a number under pressure in a call. This one clause is what stops you building forever for a share that might be zero.

1.7 Maintenance - put an end date on it

Included: bug fixes for defects in what you built, for a fixed window after launch - three months is reasonable. **Not included:** new features, OS upgrades that need rework, third-party API changes, server management, content updates. If the free

window has no end date, it is forever.

1.8 Termination and liability

- Either side can exit with written notice - 30 days is normal.
- If she terminates: you keep everything paid, you are paid for work in progress, and **the royalty survives for what already shipped**.
- **Cap your liability at the total fees you have received.** Non-negotiable. You are not insuring her business against failure.
- State explicitly: **this is a service agreement with a royalty, not a partnership**. No agency, no fiduciary duty, no shared liability for her debts. This is the clause that gives you the passive position you asked for.

1.9 Getting it drafted

Do not write this yourself from a downloaded template. A lawyer drafting a simple service agreement with a royalty runs roughly **Rs 15,000-30,000**; a review of your own careful draft is cheaper, around **Rs 8,000-15,000**. Yes, that is 6-24% of your fee, and yes it stings. But the fee is not what you are protecting - the royalty and the knowledge base are. This is the highest-return money you will spend on the project.

PART 2

Kickoff - the first week

The habits you set in week one are the habits you will have in month four. This is the cheapest leverage in the whole project.

2.1 The kickoff meeting

Agenda: confirm scope, confirm the phases, confirm what she owes you, agree the cadence, agree the channel. Then - and this is the part people skip - **send a written summary within 24 hours**. "As discussed, here is what we agreed. Please confirm." That message becomes the record, and it costs you ten minutes.

2.2 What you need from her in week one

- **The business entity and KYC for Razorpay**. Start this immediately - it can take weeks and it will block Phase 4 if it slips. This is the most likely client-side delay in the project.
- **Play Store developer account** - in her name, her business, roughly Rs 2,000.
- **The domains** - vastufirst.com and vastufirst.in, both currently available. Buy both, redirect .in to .com.
- **Brand assets**, or a decision to have you design them (which is a change request if it is not in Phase 1).
- **Written sign-off on the Vastu content approach** and on the expert review arrangement.
- **One decision-maker**. If there are two opinions in the room, you will build everything twice and be paid once.

2.3 Set the cadence and never break it

One weekly written update. Same day every week. Non-negotiable. And **one channel** - WhatsApp or email, not both. Anything decided on a call gets written up afterwards.

The reason is not admin. A client who hears from you every Friday does not panic. A client who hears nothing for two weeks invents a story about what is happening, and the story is never generous. The weekly update is not reporting - it is **anxiety management**, and it is the single highest-leverage habit in this document.

2.4 Define "done" before you start

For each phase, write down what done looks like *before* the phase begins, and have her agree it. Otherwise "done" quietly becomes whatever she thought of most recently, and you will never close a phase. Sign-off is a written "approved" against a written definition - nothing less.

PART 3

Running the work

Four months is long enough for good habits to save you and bad ones to compound.

3.1 Phase gates - the discipline that matters most

Demo, then written sign-off, then invoice, then payment, then the next phase starts. In that order, every time.

Do not start Phase N+1 before Phase N is paid. This is the line that separates professionals from people who get burned, and it will feel awkward exactly once. One exception is forgivable. Two is a pattern, and by Phase 4 you will be three phases of unpaid work deep with no leverage left.

3.2 Demos

Demo working software, not screenshots - you already have a working prototype, which is exactly why you built it. Demo on her phone, or a link she can open herself. And **never demo something broken**: reschedule instead. One bad demo costs more trust than a week's delay.

3.3 Scope creep - how it actually arrives

It never sounds like "build me a new module." It sounds like **"can we just also..."**

Your response, every time: **"Yes, that's doable. It's outside the phase scope, so let me send you a quote. Want me to?"**

Never say no flatly - it makes you difficult. Never say yes for free - it makes you a doormat, and it teaches her that the next ask is free too. **Quote it.** Half the time she will decide she does not need it, which is the quote doing its job. And when she says "it's a small thing" - small things are still change requests.

3.4 When she goes quiet

First-time founders disappear. Life, doubt, money, a bad week. Your weekly update continues regardless - it is your record. After two weeks of silence: **"I've paused work pending your feedback on X. The timeline moves by the length of the delay."** Calm, factual, no reproach.

Never keep building into a void. You will build the wrong thing, and you will eat the cost of rebuilding it.

3.5 When she panics

She will - most likely around Phase 2 or 3, when real money has gone out and there is still no product she can show anyone. This is normal and it is not about you.

The cure is preventive, not reactive: it is the weekly update. If it happens anyway, show her something running. That is what the prototype is for.

3.6 Delivering bad news

Early, in writing, with options and a recommendation. Like this:

"The plan-reading is harder than we scoped. Two options: (a) ship v1 with the user tagging rooms manually and add auto-detection in v2, or (b) extend Phase 2 by three weeks. I recommend (a) - it gets you to launch on time and the manual flow tests just as well. Your call."

Never surprise a client on a deadline. **Bad news in week two is a decision she gets to make. The same news in week twelve is a failure she has to absorb.** Clients forgive problems. They do not forgive being blindsided.

PART 4

Money

4.1 Invoicing

Keep it plain: your name and address, her business name, a sequential invoice number starting at 001, the date, what it is for, the amount, your bank details, and **"Payment due within 7 days."** Add "Not registered for GST." Number them sequentially from the first one - you will want the record at tax time and it reads as a business rather than a favour.

4.2 Payment terms

Net 7 from sign-off. Not net 30 - you are not a vendor with a credit department, you are one person. Phase 1 is paid before work begins.

4.3 When payment is late

- 1 Day 8 - friendly.** "Just checking the invoice reached you okay." Assume an oversight, because usually it is.
- 2 Day 14 - firm and factual.** "Work is paused until this clears." Not a threat. A statement.
- 3 Day 21 - stop.** Actually stop, and tell her you have. Do not escalate, do not argue, do not plead.

The pause is your entire leverage. Use it early and calmly, while the amount is small and the relationship is intact. Freelancers who let it run to three unpaid phases have no leverage left and no good options.

4.4 The royalty - the first payment sets the pattern

Quarterly, within 30 days of quarter end. She sends a statement with the payment; you reconcile it against the Play Store and Razorpay numbers.

The first quarterly payment is the one that matters. If Q1 arrives late, or vague, or "we'll sort it next quarter" - fix it immediately, that quarter, in writing. Whatever you accept the first time becomes the permanent standard. This is a ten-year relationship if the app works, and it is being defined in month five.

PART 5

Launch

5.1 Legal, before you ship

Non-negotiable: a visible entertainment/informational disclaimer (not buried in a settings page); no health, wealth, marriage or fortune guarantees anywhere; a privacy policy and DPDP consent flow (floor plans and location are personal data); terms and conditions; and a clear refund policy - hidden paywalls and refund trouble are the top complaints against every competitor you researched.

The part people miss: you must also review **her marketing copy** for ASCI compliance. If she runs "100% guaranteed Vastu results" ads, the app is implicated, not just the ad. The CCPA can penalise misleading advertising up to Rs 10 lakh for a first offence. **Write into the contract that she will not make guarantee claims**, and that the disclaimer stays in the app.

Budget roughly Rs 15,000-30,000 for a lawyer to review the disclaimer, privacy policy and terms.

5.2 Play Store

- Her account, her name, her business entity.
- The app must be genuinely feature-rich. Both stores scrutinise thin fortune-telling apps - the floor-plan engine and reports are what keep you compliant.
- Data safety declaration and content rating completed honestly.

5.3 Handover

Do this properly. It is the difference between a client who refers you and one who resents you.

- Source code, per whatever your IP clause says.
- All credentials, in a password manager - never in a WhatsApp message.
- A short architecture note: what is where, and why.
- The knowledge base, with the expert review annotations. This is the asset - hand over the licensed copy, keep your original.
- A one-page runbook: how to deploy, where things live, what to do when it breaks.

PART 6

The specific risks in this project

Generic advice ends here. These are the five things most likely to actually go wrong, in order.

6.1 Plan-reading is the hard part, and it is in Phase 2

Reading an arbitrary uploaded floor plan and knowing which shape is the toilet is genuinely hard - weeks of work, not days. The zone logic took minutes; this is the real engineering. It is also where users will drop off if it is clumsy.

Mitigation: ship v1 with the user tagging rooms on a grid, and make auto-detection v2. **Tell her this before Phase 2 starts, not during it.** Framed early it is expertise; framed late it is an excuse.

6.2 Sequence the expert review BEFORE Phase 2

The knowledge base asks reviewers to rule on M-06 and M-07 - whether the 45-degree sector method is acceptable, or whether the true 81-pada grid is required. **If they say rebuild, that is a Phase 2 rebuild.**

Phase 2 is the floor-plan engine and the rules core - the biggest phase, Rs 35,000. Building it before the review lands means risking building it twice, and eating the second time yourself.

Action: get the review back before Phase 2 starts. This may be the single most valuable sentence in this document.

6.3 The flats problem

Most urban Indian buyers buy flats, not plots. A flat buyer cannot move a wall - so the product's core promise ("change the layout before you build") does not apply to them, and all you can sell is remedies. The knowledge base asks the reviewers this directly.

If the answer is "Vastu offers a flat buyer very little", the addressable market shrinks or the product changes. **That is her risk, not yours - you are passive.** But flag it in writing now, because if it surfaces in month six it will feel like something you hid.

6.4 You cannot see the money

You chose the passive position deliberately and for good reasons. The cost of that choice is that your entire upside now depends on numbers you cannot see and execution you cannot influence. **Audit rights are not distrust - they are the only thing that makes 5% mean anything.**

6.5 The friendship is collateral on a business outcome neither of you controls

Most apps fail. That is not pessimism, it is the base rate - and it is why you took cash plus a royalty rather than pure equity. But if this one fails, **the friendship absorbs it**, and neither of you will be entirely rational about why.

The specific mechanics that catch people, all of which are harder with a friend and therefore matter more:

- **Pausing work on a late payment feels brutal.** Do it anyway, at day 14, exactly as you would with a stranger. The alternative is resentment that compounds silently.
- **"Can we just also" is far harder to refuse.** Quote it anyway. The quote is not hostility - it is information she needs to make a decision.
- **Bad news is harder to deliver** because you do not want to disappoint her personally. Deliver it earlier, not later.
- **She may unconsciously expect friend-flexibility and professional-delivery at once.** Those are different things and you cannot supply both. Name it kindly, early.
- **You will be tempted to absorb costs quietly** to keep it smooth. Every absorbed cost is a small resentment you are storing up on her behalf, without her even knowing.

6.6 Her execution is your upside

Your royalty rides entirely on a first-time founder marketing a Vastu app in a category that already contains Grihafi, Apzok and AppliedVastu. You gave up control of that on purpose, and that was a defensible trade.

But be honest with yourself now rather than in month six: **if you do not believe she can sell this, the right move is more cash upfront and less royalty - and that conversation has to happen before you sign, not after.** Once you sign, you have chosen. Live with the choice gracefully.

PART 7

The habits

None of these are difficult. That is precisely why so few people do them, and why doing them reliably is most of what "professional" actually means.

- 1 **Everything in writing.** Calls are for the relationship; writing is for the record. Every call gets a follow-up message.
- 2 **Never work ahead of payment.** The one rule that, on its own, prevents most freelance disasters.
- 3 **Under-promise on dates, then hit them.** Add 30% to every estimate you believe. You will still be late sometimes.
- 4 **Bad news early.** Always. There is no exception to this and it is the hardest one to actually do.
- 5 **Quote every change.** Never refuse, never do it free.
- 6 **Weekly update, same day, no matter what.** Especially in the weeks where you have nothing good to report - those are the weeks it is doing the most work.
- 7 **Never demo something broken.** Reschedule instead.
- 8 **Keep your own copy of everything** - code, decisions, messages, the knowledge base.
- 9 **Do not discuss your day job, your other work, or your rates with her.** Nothing good comes of any of the three.
- 10 **Be boringly reliable.** It is rarer than you would think, and it is the entire reputation. People do not refer the most talented person they have worked with. They refer the one who did not make them worry.

PART 8

Red flags

None of these mean walk away today. All of them mean: slow down, get it in writing, and reduce your exposure before you go further.

- Resists a written contract, or wants to "paper it later".
- Resists the Phase 1 upfront.
- Wants to renegotiate the royalty *after* work has started.
- Two decision-makers with different opinions and no tie-breaker.
- **Late on the Phase 1 payment.** This is the single best predictor of how Phase 5 will go. Believe it the first time.
- Asks you to make claims in the app or the marketing that you know are false.
- Treats the 5% as a favour she is doing you rather than what you are being paid.
- Pushes for the source code before final payment.

The one that should actually stop you

If she asks you to ship guarantee claims - "100% accurate", "guaranteed prosperity", anything promising an outcome - **that is where you stop and put it in writing.** Not because it is rude to ask, but because the legal exposure under ASCI and the Consumer Protection Act attaches to the product, and your name is on the build. Everything else on this page is a negotiation. That one is a line.

APPENDIX

Templates

Steal these. Adjust the tone to how you actually speak - the structure is what matters, not the words.

A. The weekly update (send every Friday, without fail)

```
Subject: VastuFirst - week of [date]

Hi [name],

SHIPPED THIS WEEK
- [thing], [thing]

NEXT WEEK
- [thing], [thing]

I NEED FROM YOU
- [thing] - blocking [what] from [date]

RISKS / NOTES
- [anything she should know early, or "nothing this week"]

Phase [N] on track for [date].
```

The "I need from you" line is the important one. It is polite, it is useful, and it quietly builds a dated record of every client-side delay - which is what you will need if the timeline slips and the reason was not you.

B. Phase sign-off request

```
Hi [name],

Phase [N] is complete. Here's what we agreed it would be:
- [definition of done, copied from the contract]

And here it is running: [link / demo time]

If that all looks right, please reply "approved" and I'll send
the invoice and start Phase [N+1].

If anything's off, tell me now and I'll fix it inside this phase.
```

C. Change request (the "can we just also" reply)

Hi [name],

Yes, that's doable and I think it's a good idea.

It sits outside the Phase [N] scope we agreed, so it'd be a change request: roughly [X] days, Rs [Y].

Two options - I can quote it properly and we slot it into this phase, or we park it for after launch. Happy either way.

Want me to send the quote?

D. Late payment - day 14

Hi [name],

Just flagging invoice [00N] from [date] is still outstanding.

I've paused work on Phase [N+1] until it clears - not a drama, just how I keep things straight. Timeline moves by however long it takes.

Let me know if there's an issue at your end I can help with.

Note the tone: no accusation, no threat, no apology either. State the pause as an operating fact rather than a punishment. It is far more effective than anger, and it leaves the relationship intact.

E. Bad news

Hi [name],

Flagging something early rather than late.

[The problem, in one plain sentence.]

Two options:

(a) [option] - [consequence]

(b) [option] - [consequence]

I'd recommend (a), because [reason].

Happy to talk it through. Your call either way.

F. When she has gone quiet

Hi [name],

Haven't heard back on [thing] since [date], so I've paused Phase [N] rather than build in the wrong direction.

Whenever you're ready - no rush at your end, I just don't want to guess and get it wrong. Timeline shifts by the gap.

LAST PAGE

If you only do seven things

- 1 **Read your Amex employment contract this week.** Before you sign hers. The job is worth more than this project by an order of magnitude, and it is the only risk here you cannot undo.
- 2 **Commit to Kotlin Multiplatform in Phase 1 architecture.** iOS is in scope at this fee, so a shared codebase is the only version of this that works. Deciding it in Phase 4 costs more than the entire iOS scope. Set up Codemagic's free tier early and get a real iPhone for QA.
- 3 **Put an end date on the consultancy.** "During the build, ending at launch." One line. It costs nothing and it is the difference between a scope item and a permanent obligation.
- 4 **Get the contract signed** - "5% of revenue", audit rights, an exit clause, and the knowledge base retained as yours. Pay a lawyer. It is the best money in the project, and with a friend it matters more, not less.
- 5 **Take the Rs 25,000 before you start.**
- 6 **Get the expert review back before Phase 2 begins.** Otherwise you may build the engine twice and be paid once.
- 7 **Send the Friday update every single week.** It is the whole relationship, and it costs ten minutes.

One last thing, honestly

This is your first commercial project, and the way you have run it so far - researching before building, correcting the knowledge base when it turned out to be wrong, refusing to claim you were first when you were not - is already better than most people manage on their fifth.

The failure mode for someone like you is not sloppiness. It is being **too accommodating**: absorbing one more small change, letting one payment slide, staying quiet about a problem because the relationship feels good and you do not want to be difficult. Every item in this document is really a defence against that one instinct.

And notice what has already happened. Between the proposal and today, the scope quietly gained an entire second platform and an open-ended advisory role, and the fee did not move. Nobody did anything wrong - this is simply how it goes when the client is a friend and you are both being generous. But it is exactly the pattern this document exists to interrupt, and it happened before you had even signed.

The Rs 1,25,000 is not the point. **A shipped product, a clean reference, a knowledge base you own, and a royalty that might compound for a decade** - that is the point. Protect those four things and it will not matter much whether this particular app wins.